

Bronze Age

The Bronze Age describes a period in time when some societies learned to produce tools made from bronze. At the same time, these societies become more dependent on farming and trade. The Bronze Age did not occur at the same time for all societies, but generally the Bronze Age followed the late Stone Age.

! WOW!

Thank the Bronze Age that you're **reading this!** It was at this time that **writing and counting systems** were **developed!**

What is bronze?

Bronze is a mixture of two metals: copper and tin. When mixed together these two metals are both harder and more long-lasting than they are by themselves.



Hot, melting bronze being poured

Why was it so special?

Bronze is made from materials that were easy to mine. It is also an easy metal to melt and mold into shape. Bronze tools, such as axes and swords, were harder and more hard-wearing than stone tools.



Mold for bronze pins



Finished pin in bronze

Weapons

Bronze Age societies were often at war with each other and this made bronze swords and armor important for their effectiveness when fighting.



Tools

Bronze tools, such as axes, were necessary to help clear land for farming. Flint tools were still being used by some Bronze Age people, but not to the extent they were in the Stone Age.



Late bronze ax head



Flint knife